

PS50008A Textbook

Research Methods & Experimental Design

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1 Welcome

This textbook accompanies PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design at Goldsmiths, University of London. It contains all lecture and lab readings organised by week, along with self-assessment quizzes to check your understanding.

2 How to Use This Textbook

Each week has **two readings** to complete:

1. **Lecture reading** — Read before or after Wednesday's lecture to reinforce the concepts
2. **Lab reading** — Read before Thursday's lab to prepare for practical exercises

After each week, test your understanding with the self-assessment quiz. These match the style of the MCQ exam.

PDF Downloads

Each chapter and quiz can be downloaded as a PDF for offline reading. Look for the PDF link at the top of each page.

3 Weekly Readings

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
11	Week 11 Lecture: Introduction to Research	Week 11 Lab: DataLab Foundations	Week 11 Quiz
12	Week 12 Lecture: Research Design Framework	Week 12 Lab: Descriptive Statistics in R	Week 12 Quiz
13	Week 13 Lecture: Correlation & Relationships	Week 13 Lab: Correlation in R	Week 13 Quiz
14	Week 14 Lecture: Probability & Distributions	Week 14 Lab: Visualising Distributions in R	Week 14 Quiz

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
15	Week 15 Lecture: Significance Testing	Week 15 Lab: Running t-tests in R	Week 15 Quiz
—	<i>Reading Week</i>	—	—
16	Week 16 Lecture: Research Plan Tips	Week 16 Lab: Literature Review Skills	Week 16 Quiz
17	Week 17 Lecture: MCQ Practice & Credibility	Week 17 Lab: Methodology Workshop	Week 17 Quiz
18	Week 18 Lecture: MCQ Exam Preparation	Week 18 Lab: Ethics & Procedures	Week 18 Quiz
19	Week 19 Lecture: Results & Lab Report Writing	Week 19 Lab: Data Collection Support	Week 19 Quiz
20	Week 20 Lecture: Discussion & EDS Preparation	Week 20 Lab: Data Analysis Workshop	Week 20 Quiz

! Week 12 is Critical

Week 12 introduces ALL the terminology you need for your Research Plan: IV, DV, design types, hypothesis types, test selection, and descriptive statistics.

4 Assessment Deadlines

Week	Assessment
16	Research Plan due Friday (20%)
18	MCQ Exam Wednesday (20%)
20	EDS Assignment due Friday (20%)
Post-term	Research Report due 1 May (40%)

5 Quick Reference

- Assessment Overview
- Resources
- Data Dictionary
- Schedule